

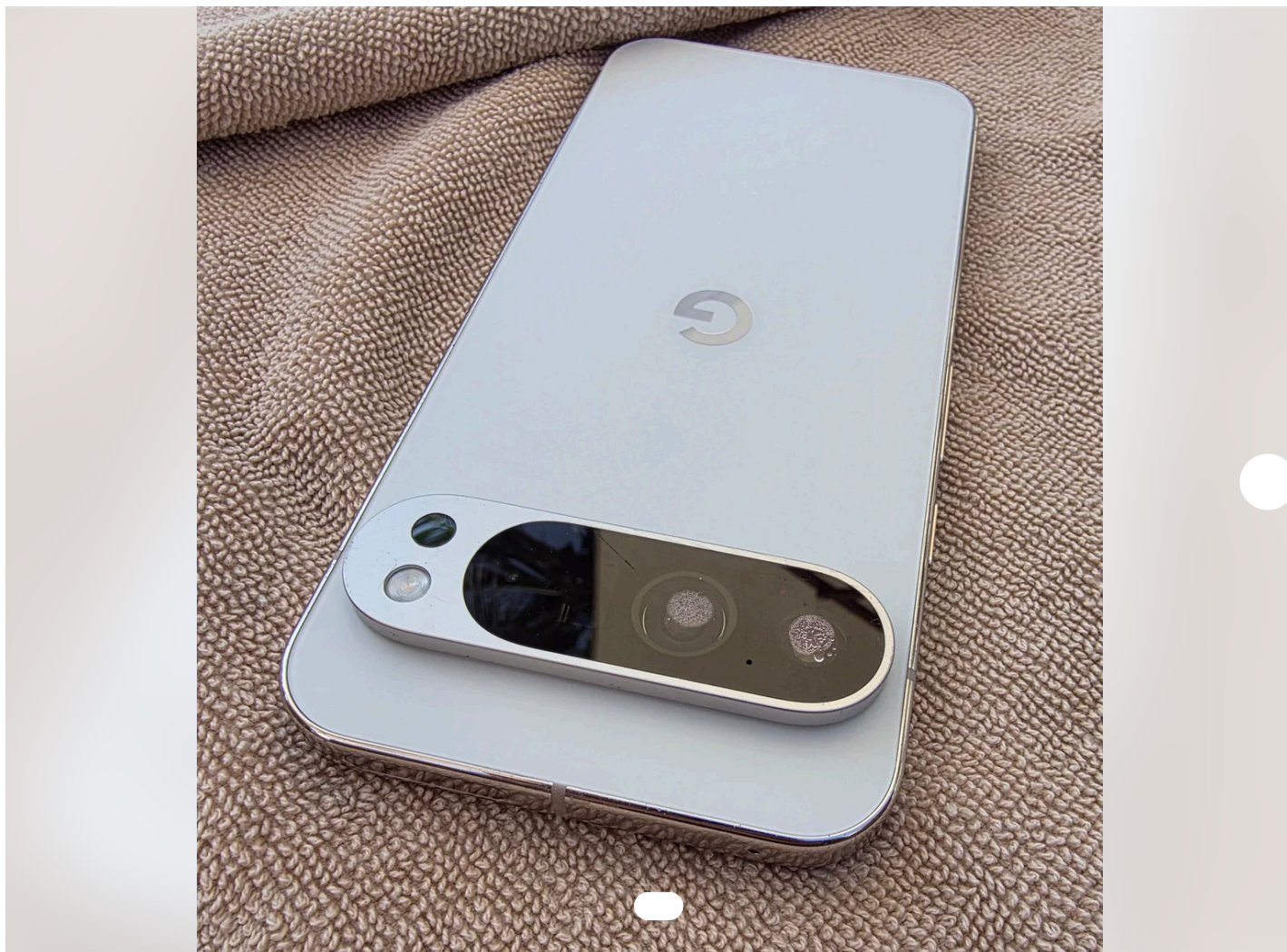
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**r/pixel_phones** • 1mo ago

HazAnwar

Google Pixel 9 Pro XL - Failed RMA



I went on holiday, and my phone stopped working (completely dead); I noticed that there was some condensation/water in the camera bump (it rained a little bit that day, but IP68, right?)

Well, I came back home (to the UK) and sent it off for Google RMA (to Poland), and they stated that it's water-damaged and want to charge me £865 to repair/replace it, even though the phone is supposed to have an IP68 rating and there's no damage anywhere on the phone, it's been very well maintained!

On top of that, there's no way to contact, respond or dispute this directly with anyone from the repair team. I tried the standard customer service route, who weren't helpful and just kept saying **"a partially discolored LDI indicator means that the repair will not be covered under warranty"**.

I also noticed that the camera lens was coming loose (which appears to be a widespread issue with the Google Pixel 9 series after some research), some example Reddit posts: [example 1](#), [example 2](#), [example 3](#) (there are many more), which I explained. So if water got into the phone, it's quite clearly a manufacturing fault, but they kept on reiterating that their "specialist" decision was "final", and I would have to pay for the full amount; and on top of that, there's no way to escalate to anyone!

I cannot fathom how this is acceptable?! This is extremely atrocious customer service. I'm beyond disappointed. I will definitely not be buying another Google Pixel in the future

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 vc-10 • 1mo ago

If you're in the UK, I would contact the retailer who sold you the phone and state that the device was clearly not fit for purpose under the Consumer Rights Act.

The law states that the device has to be fit for purpose as advertised. They advertise water resistance, and parts falling off is obviously not acceptable either.

I am not a lawyer, but I've had success with getting things sorted when the appropriate legislation is quoted!



 HazAnwar OP • 1mo ago

I purchased online from the Google Store and tried the customer service route and did state I wanted to make a claim under the Consumer Rights Act but I believe the customer service is based elsewhere and they were of no help whatsoever



 vc-10 • 1mo ago

If they're refusing, then it might be worth contacting your bank. I'd also suggest speaking with Citizens Advice.



 aagha786 • 1mo ago

If you bought with a credit card, have you looked into if they offer extra warranty coverage?



 [deleted] • 1mo ago

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Yep...part of it might be that manufacturers are on very short timelines to develop new annual phones to appease buyers and reviewers who demand something new every year. Included in aggressive timelines is compressed opportunities to test...hardware, software, and, in this case, the body. It isn't just phones...it's a trend in a variety of electronics (TVs, PCs, etc.).

**chic_luke** • 1mo ago

100% this. Also, we are in an era where changes are so incremental, I wouldn't be mad at 2-year release cycles.

**[deleted]** • 1mo ago

Dude they have waterproof certs and the adhesive is not heat or waterproof lmao

**UncleCunk** • 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

Google is just finding the easy way out by saying it's your fault for water damage when the 9 series has a known issue of the camera bump detaching. I bet you any money the water damage is because of the MANUFACTURER DEFECT that is the camera bump.

**WildSail1228** • 1mo ago

This is why I couldn't pull the trigger to go with the Pixel. Great design (aesthetically), great software, but has tons of quality issues and has a mid range chip that doesn't justify the flagship price.

No matter how fanbois try to spin it otherwise.

**Scarboroughwarning** • 1mo ago

Good design, good software, shite QC

**klonoax** • 1mo ago

I had the camera separation issue. Sent it in but they told me there was other issues with it I guess. I didn't want to argue so I paid your 130 they wanted and they sent me a refurbished one

**horatiobanz** • 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

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for warranty service and a way to charge them for it, always making money.

**iwannabeaprettygirl** • 1mo ago

This same issue killed my 9 pro back in August :(

**cutebluedragongirl** • 1mo ago

Pixel phones are probably the least durable phones on the market.

**horatiobanz** • 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

They are the least reliable phone brand in the world. And it's not even close, they are off on their own island away from every other brand who are all clumped together.

<https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/s/byF2DjAht9>

**HeftyCs** • 1mo ago

I just got a replacement for my google lens falling off, I was a month out of warranty. They would NOT replace it for free at first, even called it a 'Out of warranty manufacturing defect' or some crap like that, and I was alluded to that it was free, then I got the RMA request emails and they wanted me to pay \$100. I was baffled, because its not been dropped, wasn't my fault, and was entirely on Googles manufacturing. I went back, and was able to have them file it as frame damage and came back for \$0. Shocked because I had seen plenty of people get help, overall was satisfied because I got it fixed and a Refurbed unit to my door, but I was baffled that It was "free" until it was \$100

**Funky_Air** • 1mo ago

Google should've done what Apple has done with iPhone 17 Pro camera bump.

**PixelCommunity** • 26d ago

Top 1% Commenter

Hey, can you please check your chat? I just sent you a message.

**Background_Bed_5410** • 26d ago

Hi Pixel community, would you be interested in seeing the manual for Android 5 Lollipop that Google support sent me for my Google Pixel 9a?

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and sim tray broken and power button broken? And guess which one has zero cracks. Never buying a pixel again.



Oli_Heinz_Schubkarre • 1mo ago

S22 is the worst phone ever. The battery is a joke.



PleasantOrange9154 • 1mo ago

Same happend to me i will never buy a pixel again ..

Its really sad i Loved that Phone ..

But this is Not Acceptable



Izan_TM • 1mo ago

it's very common for warranties to not cover water damage on devices that are advertised as water resistant

it's slimy, but unless you purchase insurance no phone brands will be likely to help you with similar failures



horatiobanz • 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

It's also common for manufacturers to build phones where the camera bumps don't fall off.



TheIndulgers • 1mo ago

At this point, it is your own fault. Everyone knows how awful Google's QC is, and even worse customer support and warranty.

If you buy a pixel, you are signing yourself up for being scammed by a trillion dollar corporation.

Take this as a lesson learned.



Mitsuplex • 1mo ago

My friend used a blow dryer to remove the condensation. Be careful to not overdue it. Removed the droplets and they were able to fully RMA.



HazAnwar [OP](#) • 1mo ago

I think the issue is that the liquid indicators (on the phone's motherboard) have already been triggered, and that process is not reversible without opening up the phone and replacing the indicators.

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**MoarNootNoot** • 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

If the camera bump was separated from the body even a bit you can kiss the IP68 rating bye bye. It's unfortunate what happened to you. You could keep calling back and see if you get someone else, but tbh you'd just be wasting your time. Sell the phone for parts online and buy something else.

**maxence1994** • 1mo ago

Could a case prevent that?

**HazAnwar** OP • 1mo ago

It was in a case; I took it out of the case to take pictures, so unfortunately, not

**maxence1994** • 1mo ago

Oh, crapping crap...

**Syynn_** • 1mo ago

I was just gonna buy a pixel 10 pro xl but I was afraid about the warranty as apples warranty is superior . Phone is boring but ! I guess it happens right

**maewemeetagain** • 1mo ago

This happened to any other phone, you would get the exact same treatment from any other company. Water damage isn't covered by warranty, no matter what story you give for how it happened. They can't give everyone who says "I never dropped my phone once!" free repairs, you know.

**RedditUserData** • 1mo ago

While it's true that any other manufacturer would do the same we shouldn't let them off the hook. They advertise a specific rating ip68. Buried in the fine print it says that rating can go away at any time through normal use.

Either they shouldn't be allowed to advertise a rating that they specifically state goes away through normal use or they need to honor the rating for the warranty. It's a scam to advertise a feature and then say it could go away at any time.

**Ezrampage15** • 1mo ago

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**HazAnwar** OP • 1mo ago

Precisely my issue. Had the camera bump not come loose, it would have still been water resistant. The camera bump issue is 100% a manufacturing issue given how many cases there are of it happening, but Google refuses to acknowledge and accept responsibility for this issue

**HazAnwar** OP • 1mo ago

I'm not disputing that, but how can a phone which is supposedly water-resistant get water inside without it being damaged?

The camera bump falling off is a known issue on the Pixel 9 series, which is clearly how the water got into the phone; therefore, it's a manufacturing fault, and they should take responsibility for that

**[deleted]** • 1mo ago**Giantmeteor_we_needU** • 1mo ago

Water resistance typically isn't covered under warranty. It's a feature but not a guarantee.

**xinco64** • 1mo ago

That would actually be false advertising. They can't really claim something is IP68 and not back it up by warranty.

This is certainly subject to local laws and the specifics of the warranty. But they aren't going to escape completely on this one.

Of course, it might take a class action lawsuit or government intervention to force their hand.

**Giantmeteor_we_needU** • 1mo ago

It's not and it's not Pixel unique, try to bring a wet phone to Samsung or OnePlus, they'll laugh at you. All phones are IP68 as they leave factory. But the thing is that water resistance can be easily compromised by physical damage, high temperatures, exposure of the adhesive to salt or chlorine (sweat, pool water) etc. Basically, it's like the screen - all screens are supposed to 100% work from the factory. But if you get OLED rot on your screen, it's normally not warrantied because often it caused by physical impact, and all manufacturers will claim mishandling. The same with water resistance, they'll tell that you dropped the phone and physical damage compromised the seal. That's just how it is in real world.

**xinco64** • 1mo ago

It's the age old problem of warranties. They are only as good as the companies policies backing them up. And where there is an actual product problem that causes widespread problems, they first blame the user. Which is actually justifiable, as users are users and do stupid user things.

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matter is, it still is probably the user unless the design/manufacturing problem is large enough that it exceeds user stupidity problems. Which is a pretty high bar.

So me, being perfect, is screwed because of all the other idiots out there. So says everyone. (But I'm the only one who is right, of course)

**Giantmeteor_we_needU** • 1mo ago

Pretty much, that's why if you want your phone issues fixed you need to have a protection plan. It is optional but it's the only way to be covered most of the times. Google Care for P9PXL is \$199 for 2 years, covers all damage including accidental, and well worth for \$1100 phone imo.

**maewemeetagain** • 1mo ago

You strike me as somebody who works in the industry too. Very rare that I see another person who understands how this works.

**Giantmeteor_we_needU** • 1mo ago

I don't, however I worked in electronics sales many years ago and have dealt with warranties more than an average user. I've learned quickly that having a manufacturer's warranty doesn't mean that every issue with the product will get fixed for free, especially the issues that involve visual signs of physical damage or moisture.

**n_dion** • 1mo ago

The problem with IP rating is that it doesn't mean that the phone will survive after contact with water. This rating just means that after contacting water for X mins phone still works.

But that phone can fail next day or in a week and it will still get that IP rating.

And even worse: IP rating is single contact only. It could happens that IP68 phone may be damaged by daily clean with wet wipes...

**horatiobanz** • 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

This happens to any other phone and the tech press would never let anyone forget about it. It would be in every single future review of that companies phones. Yet Google can have like 43 active recalls going on, exploding batteries, systemic bricking of phones, camera bumps and buttons falling off, several other unrecognized hardware defects like the P8P WiFi and Bluetooth permanent failure, and it's fuckin crickets from everyone and nobody mentions that Pixels have BY FAR the worst reliability of any phone brand in the world.

mwmcc • 1mo ago

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phone to fail (including the moisture indicators)? For sufficient water to get past the case, through the camera bump space (which I agree needs to be properly addressed), and cause the phone to fail...were you actively using it in the rain? Or set it down with the camera facing up? If not, these things are that sensitive...even to something like high humidity? Before IPXX values became a thing...phones must've been built different...hence the rice trick that used to revive many phones:)

**HazAnwar** OP • 1mo ago

The cut-out for the camera is not super tight, so I guess that didn't really prevent anything from getting in. But yeah, I was in a country with quite high humidity and was just using it in light rain, not enough for it to have been badly damaged, but it stopped working shortly after.

**slavikthedancer** • 1mo ago

Can you sue them?

**u/sokenny** • Promoted

Everyone wants AI insights. Almost nobody validates them

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Thumbnail image:

Everyone wants AI insights. Almost nobody validates them

[gostellar.app](#)**BeneficialBid7961** • 1mo ago

The IP6x rating means nothing these days. The regulation around the ratings is not secure. It's broken and corrupt. I've had a Pixel 5 phone fail from a light splash. Google refused to warrant the repairs as water damage is somehow not covered even though they all have IP6x ratings.

The loose camera bezel SHOULD be covered under Google warranty and/or your country's trading safeguards.

**horatiobanz** • 1mo ago • Edited 1mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

This is what you get when you buy the world's least reliable phone brand. People keep trying to sound the alarm to consumers and keep getting downvoted, because these Pixel subreddits are here to defend the corporation, not the consumer, much like the modern reviewers and tech press

**josh91117** • 1mo ago



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And since i heard about the camera bump failure i check mine from time to time just in case and i already checked back panels online just in case i ever need to replace it all.

I have a pro xl and just got a pro cause i wanted a compact phone again.



Digiee-fosho • 1mo ago

IP6x doesn't prevent condensation from high humidity with change in temperature. Remember to always put in a bag of rice if you drop phones in snow or ice

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